

100 Days of Linux - Day 086

Title: Revision Quiz – Environment Variables & Aliases

Today's Goal

Review everything learned about environment variables, shell variables, exporting variables, permanent variables and aliases.

Why This Matters

These features are used daily to configure development environments, automate workflows and improve productivity.

Revision Summary

Topics covered: **env**, **printenv**, shell variables, **export**, **~/.bashrc**, **source**, **alias** and **unalias**.

Practice Questions

1. Display all environment variables.
2. Display only the HOME variable.
3. Export a variable named COURSE with the value Linux and verify it.
4. Create an alias named ll for **ls -l** and use it.
5. Save a permanent alias named cls for **clear** in **~/.bashrc** and reload the file.

Hints

Think about which command lists variables, which exports them, and how to reload **~/.bashrc** after editing.

Mini Challenge

Create a Markdown file named **env_alias_notes.md** containing three environment variables and three useful aliases from your system.

Common Mistakes

Using spaces around '=', forgetting to reload **~/.bashrc**, or expecting temporary aliases to persist after opening a new terminal.

Did You Know?

Many professional developers customise their shell with aliases and environment variables to save time every day.

Pro Tip

Keep custom variables and aliases grouped under clearly labelled comments inside **~/.bashrc**.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: **env** or **printenv**

Q2: **printenv HOME**

Q3: **export COURSE=Linux** then **printenv COURSE**

Q4: **alias ll='ls -l'** then **ll**

Q5: Add **alias cls='clear'** to **~/.bashrc** and run **source ~/.bashrc**.

Homework

Recreate today's exercises without looking at your notes and verify that your permanent aliases work in a new terminal.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll begin learning Linux package management with the **apt** command.